

Paraben Diet



What is it?

People with allergic contact dermatitis can be so sensitive to their allergen that they must avoid skin exposure AND ingestion (eating) of the chemical. This type of allergy could cause dermatitis on the eyelids, hands, face, around the mouth, or at the skin folds (armpits, groin). Some people may have dermatitis all over their bodies.

For some people allergic to paraben, a diet low in paraben can reduce the likelihood of skin reactions. The level of paraben required to produce a response is unknown and can vary from patient to patient. A two-month trial of removing foods and beverages that contain paraben is recommended.

Parabens (parahydroxybenzoic acid) are preservatives with anti-microbial properties and can be listed as additives in food.

- Methylparaben (food additive E218)
- Ethylparaben (food additive E214)
- Propylparaben (food additive E216)

In the past, they were commonly used in foods. Today, they are only used in a few products.

The goal is a low paraben diet. In general, avoid doughnuts, other cake-type desserts, and pizza rolls.

References:

Dermatitis 2006;17: 214.

Environment International 2013;57-58:68-74.

Environ Sci Technol 2013;47:3918-3925.

Reprod Toxicol 2015;52:93-100.

<https://www.chemicalsafetyfacts.org/>

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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Paraben Diet



FOODS TO AVOID

Beverages (Alcoholic)		
Beer	Wine	
Beverages (Other)		
Cider	Iced Tea	Soft Drinks
Fruit & Vegetable Juices	Liquid Dietary Food Supplements	
Condiments		
Fats	Oils	Spiced Sauces
Flavoring Syrups	Pancake Syrup	Tomato Pulp/Puree
Ketchup	Pickles	Toppings
Mayonnaise	Relish	
Mustard	Salad Dressings	
Dairy		
Frozen Dairy Foods	Yogurt	
Desserts/Sweets		
Cakes	Icings	Pie crust
Cookies	Jam	Muffins
Doughnuts	Jelly	Pudding
Gelatin	Marmalade	Sugar substitutes (artificial sweeteners)
Packaged Products		
Dried meat surface coating	Meats/Fish/Poultry	Processed vegetables
Jelly coatings of meat products	Packaged meats/fish/poultry	Sausage rolls
Marinated & preserved fish products	Prepackaged tortillas	Other
Snacks		
Cereal	Potato Snacks	Trail Mix
Coated Nuts	Soft Candy	
Other		
Pizza Rolls		

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Paraben Diet



Paraben-containing medications

Medication	Butyl paraben	Methyl paraben	Propyl paraben
Acebutolol		X	X
Acetaminophen	X		
Acyclovir		X	X
Advil		X	X
Alendronate	X	X	X
Aluminum/magnesium/simethicone	X	X	
Aluminum hydroxide	X	X	
Amantadine		X	X
Aminocaproic acid		X	X
Amoxicillin		X	X
Apap/codeine		X	X
Aripiprazole		X	X
Benzonatate	X	X	X
Butalbital/APAP/caffeine		X	X
Ceftibuten	X	X	X
Cefuroxime		X	X
Cetirizine		X	X
Chlordiazepoxide	X	X	X
Citalopram		X	X
Clomipramine		X	X
Cycloserine	X	X	X
Diphenhydramine	X	X	X
Entecavir		X	X
Ergocalciferol	X	X	X
Fexofenadine	X	X	
Flucytosine			
Fluoxetine	X	X	X
Fluvastatin	X	X	X
Guaifenesin		X	X
Hydroxyurea	X	X	X
Ibuprofen	X		
Ibuprofen/pseudoephedrine		X	X
Isotretinoin		X	X
Levocarnitine		X	X
Loxapine	X	X	X
Morphine sulfate		X	
Namenda		X	X
Nortriptyline	X	X	X
Olanzapine ODT		X	X
Phenytoin sodium	X	X	X
Piroxicam		X	X
Paroxetine		X	X
Prednisolone	X		
Ranitidine	X	X	
Rimantadine		X	X
Temazepam	X	X	X
Tetracycline	X	X	X
Theophylline	X	X	X

X means that the medication may contain paraben

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